Generated from the competition table

1996 Men's Ballon d'Or

Everything the Men's Ballon d'Or table records about 1996, with the winner linked to their full award history and their national team linked to its own record.

Winner	National team	Ceremony date
Matthias Sammer	Germany	24 December 1996

← Previous edition (PDF)
1995

Next edition (PDF) →
1997

All Men's Ballon d'Or editions →

📚 References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed:9 October 2026

- Official winners and rankings (https://ballondor.com/all-rankings)
- Official homepage (https://ballondor.com/)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 1 of 5) (https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/europa-poy65.html)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 2 of 5) (https://www.britannica.com/topic/Ballon-dOr)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 3 of 5) (https://www.jeuneafrique.com/381505/politique/jour-26-decembre-1995-george-weah-elu-ballon-dor/)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 4 of 5) (https://www.voanews.com/)

- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 5 of 5) (https://www.uefa.com/uefachampionsleague/news/)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 1 of 9) (https://www.si.com/soccer/what-is-the-kopa-trophy-past-winners-nominees-2025)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 2 of 9) (https://www.90min.com/what-is-kopa-trophy-past-winners-nominees)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 3 of 9) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/kopa-trophy.htm)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 4 of 9) (https://www.sportsdunia.com/football-analysis/list-of-kopa-trophy-winners)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 5 of 9) (https://www.chaseyoursport.com/football/list-of-kopa-trophy-winners/8061)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 6 of 9) (https://www.givemesport.com/every-winner-kopa-trophy-ranked/)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 7 of 9) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kopa_Trophy)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 8 of 9) (https://www.fcbarcelona.com/en/football/first-team/news/4367534/lamine-yamal-retains-kopa-trophy/featured)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 9 of 9) (https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2025/lamine-yamal-retains-kopa-trophy-for-best-young-player-vicky-lopez-takes-inaugural-womens-prize_sto23224406/story.shtml)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 1 of 11) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/yashin-trophy.htm)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 2 of 11) (https://www.premierleague.com/en/news/4420829/donnarumma-and-gyokeres-win-awards-at-2025-ballon-dor)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 3 of 11) (https://goaltheball.com/yashin-trophy-winners-list/)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 4 of 11) (https://www.fotmob.com/el/news/x3syvn394xhu179pkuk2k9k4y/ballon-d'or-2019-liverpool-goalkeeper-alisson-wins-inaugural-yachine-trophy)

- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 5 of 11) (https://www.goal.com/en-ca/lists/aston-villa-and-argentina-goalkeeper-emiliano-martinez-retains-yashin-trophy-as-world-s-best-goalkeeper-in-2024/blt47f77564722f26b5)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 6 of 11) (https://fr.wikipedia.org/wiki/Troph%C3%A9e_Yachine)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 7 of 11) (https://www.footmercato.net/a7278391082899020163-ballon-dor-2025-gianluigi-donnarumma-remporte-le-trophee-yachine)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 8 of 11) (https://www.realmadrid.com/en-US/news/football/first-team/special-features/courtois-yashin-trophy-winner-2022)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 9 of 11) (https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2022/ballon-dor-2022-thibaut-courtois-wins-yashin-trophy-for-best-goalkeeper-after-real-madrid-heroics-la_sto9191911/story.shtml)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 10 of 11) (https://www.90min.com/posts/emiliano-martinez-wins-2023-yashin-trophy)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 11 of 11) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/emiliano-martinez-wins-back-to-back-yachine-trophy-awards-1335839)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 1 of 10) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/striker-of-the-year.htm)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 2 of 10) (https://www.90min.com/what-is-gerd-muller-trophy-past-winners-nominees)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 3 of 10) (https://www.gamereactor.eu/what-is-the-gerd-muller-trophy-and-who-will-win-this-year-at-ballon-dor-2025-1605433/)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 4 of 10) (https://www.arsenal.com/news/viktor-gyokeres-wins-gerd-muller-trophy)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 5 of 10) (https://fcbayern.com/en/news/2022/10/muller-trophy-for-year%E2%80%99s-best-striker-awarded-for-the-first-time-at-the-ballon-dor-ceremony)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 6 of 10) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gerd_M%C3%BCller_Trophy)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 7 of 10) (https://www.bavarianfootballworks.com/2022/10/18/23409746/robert-lewandowski-striker-award-2022-gerd-muller-fc-barcelona-bayern-munich-alum-haaland-benzema)

- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 8 of 10) (https://www.fcbarcelona.com/en/news/2858120/lewandowski-wins-inaugural-gerd-muller-trophy/featured)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 9 of 10) (https://www.fourfourtwo.com/features/ballon-dor-what-is-the-gerd-muller-trophy)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 10 of 10) (https://sports.yahoo.com/article/won-gerd-muller-trophy-2025-201726350.html)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 1 of 9) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johan_Cruyff_Trophy_(France_Football))
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 2 of 9) (https://www.goal.com/en-us/lists/carlo-ancelotti-men-s-coach-of-year-ballon-d-or-ceremony-xabi-alonso-pep-guardiola/blt4f9630905d966f8d)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 3 of 9) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/real-madrid-boss-ancelotti-wins-men-s-johan-cruyff-trophy-1335838)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 4 of 9) (https://www.beinsports.com/en-us/soccer/articles-video/ancelotti-is-the-best-coach-of-the-year-2024-10-28)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 5 of 9) (https://www.managingmadrid.com/2024/10/28/24282158/carlo-ancelotti-wins-coach-of-the-year-award)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 6 of 9) (https://sports.yahoo.com/article/psg-head-coach-luis-enrique-193800045.html)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 7 of 9) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/luis-enrique-wins-2025-johan-cruyff-trophy-for-world-s-best-coach-1374497)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 8 of 9) (https://www.caughtoffside.com/2025/09/22/ballon-dor-2025-luis-enrique-best-coach/)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 9 of 9) (https://tribuna.com/en/news/2025-09-22-luis-enrique-wins-johan-cruyff-trophy-at-2025-ballon-dor/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 1 of 11) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/S%C3%B3crates_Award)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 2 of 11) (https://www.peace-sport.org/socrates-award/)

- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 3 of 11) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/the-senegalese-sadio-mane-becomes-the-first-winner-of-the-socrates-award-at-the-2022-ballon-dor-ceremony/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 4 of 11) (https://fcbayern.com/en/news/2022/10/sadio-mane-the-inaugural-winner-of-the-socrates-award)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 5 of 11) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/vinicius-junior-wins-socrates-award-at-the-2023-ballon-dor-ceremony/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 6 of 11) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/vinicius-wins-socrates-2023-award-for-his-humanitarian-work-1287586)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 7 of 11) (https://www.90min.com/what-is-socrates-award-past-winners-nominees)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 8 of 11) (https://www.olympics.com/en/news/ballon-dor-2025-all-winners-all-awards-complete-list-live-updates)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 9 of 11) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/h-s-h-prince-albert-ii-and-peace-and-sport-welcome-the-xana-foundation-winner-of-the-2025-socrates-award-in-monaco-2/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 10 of 11) (https://www.monaco-tribune.com/en/2025/09/ballon-dor-2025-ceremony-princess-charlene-presents-socrates-prize-to-xana-foundation/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 11 of 11) (https://www.gamereactor.eu/luis-enriques-xana-foundation-named-after-his-late-daughter-wins-socrates-award-for-humanitarian-work-1605953/)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 1 of 10) (https://www.guinnessworldrecords.com/world-records/788751-oldest-winner-of-footballs-soccers-ballon-dor-award)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 2 of 10) (https://ballondor.com/news/posts/who-is-the-oldest-ballon-dor-winner)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 3 of 10) (https://ballondor.com/news/posts/who-is-the-youngest-winner-in-the-history-of-the-ballon-dor)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 4 of 10) (https://sports.yahoo.com/article/ballon-dor-oldest-player-ever-100500974.html)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 5 of 10) (https://sports.yahoo.com/article/yamal-break-record-youngest-ballon-105500980.html)

- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 6 of 10) (https://www.beinsports.com/en-us/soccer/articles/who-was-the-youngest-ballon-d-or-winner-2026-08-23)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 7 of 10) (https://www.si.com/soccer/the-youngest-ballon-dor-winner-ever)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 8 of 10) (https://www.givemesport.com/88101605-who-is-the-oldest-ever-ballon-dor-winner/)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 9 of 10) (https://www.oldest.org/sports/youngest-ballon-dor-winner/)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 10 of 10) (https://www.oldest.org/sports/oldest-ballon-dor-winners/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 1 of 6) (https://sportsdigest.in/youngest-golden-boot-award-winners/195571/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 2 of 6) (https://worldsoccertalk.com/world-cup/list-of-world-cup-golden-boot-winners-every-top-scorer-from-1930-to-present/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 3 of 6) (https://www.si.com/soccer/2018/07/15/world-cup-golden-boot-award-winners-top-scorer-history)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 4 of 6) (https://briefly.co.za/sports/104632-ronaldo-shatters-37-year-record-after-winning-golden-boot-euro-2020-championship/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 5 of 6) (https://yen.com.gh/sports/190306-ronaldo-shatters-37-year-record-after-winning-golden-boot-euro-2020-championship/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 6 of 6) (https://onmanorama.com/sports/football/2021/07/12/european-championships-golden-boot-winners-list-ronaldo.html)

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.